

FIRST PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH



BELLTOWER *October 2025*

On behalf of Blackhawk Presbytery, the Presbytery of Lake Huron ordained Nikelle Johnson to the ministry of Minister of Word and Sacrament on Sunday, September 21. It was a joy to have family and friends from throughout my past be a part of the worship service honoring God's call on my life to serve in pastoral ministry. There were former youth directors and Sunday school teachers from my growing up years (maybe even a few that remember me when I was in the nursery). There were long time family and friends who helped to celebrate. There were former pastors and church members from churches where I have served alongside in ministry (in Christian Education). And there were new friends who were represented too! The PNC and many spouses were able to attend, and I know some of you were able to join online.





ANNOUNCEMENTS

Our Prayer Chain is now being handled by Susie Smith and Evelyn Thomas. You can contact Susie if you have a request to share and she will email the Prayer Chain. Evelyn will be Susie's backup. If you submit a request to the Prayer Chain it will be held in confidence with only those members and the pastor, until you share on Sunday morning or yourself. If you would like to be on the Prayer Chain let Susie or Evelyn know and you will be added. Thank you to all those who pray for the requests we receive.

PRESBYTERIAN WOMEN

Meals on Wheels

A sincere thank you to our volunteers who served Meals on Wheels September 8-19, 2025. Allen & Bonnie Cumberland, Phil Devers & Susie Jones, Peg Hamilton, Chuck & Vicki Jones, Jane Landreth, Jim Rickert & Carol Shippert, Betty Russell, Susie Smith and Phil & Toni Vella

Presbyterian Women

SCHOOL DONATIONS

Again this year our generous congregation has made it possible for our church to help students in need in this area as well as students in need in other countries. Thank you so much for the generous financial donations received in answer to our request. From your giving, Church World Service will receive 40 kits filled with school supplies (and cover the processing fees for each kit) and give a donation to Tools for Schools, a local program to give school supplies in a backpack to Dixon students. Additional financial gifts for school supplies from our Presbyterian Women Fund have been given to Lee, Ogle and Whiteside County schools through the Regional Office of Education. Your kind giving is reaching many students in need. Thank you also to Bonnie Cumberland for sewing the 40 cloth bags for CWS and filling the kits with supplies your donations purchased. Thank you also to Tracy Mikol, Bonnie's daughter, for delivering the boxes filled with completed kits to the CWS depot in Elgin. Thank you to all that help us complete this project for another year reaching those in need in our area as well as farther away.

Presbyterian Women

MISSION & WITNESS

Hi Ho, Hi Ho It's off to work we go. The newest Habitat house is almost ready for its occupant--all that is needed is some finishing work. We at First Presbyterian have enlisted a group of volunteers to put the final touches on the house on **October 25th**. But we could always use more if you want to volunteer. David Badger will be more than happy to add your name to the volunteer sign up sheet in the Narthex.



The Mission/Witness Committee, in collaboration with several Dixon churches, will be throwing a **Housewarming Shower** for our newest Habitat family on **Saturday, October 25th at 1:00 p.m. here in our Social Hall.** Each of the churches will shower the family with items needed for a specific room. We would gratefully appreciate donations to purchase items for the room we select. And, of course, everyone is invited to the shower. Please memo your contributions: Habitat Shower

There is an opening on the Habitat Board. If you are interested in serving in this way talk with Tim Tedrick. Lois has his phone number.

Each Wednesday we join in prayer as a community. We invite you to join us.

Dear Lord, If we fill our hours with regrets over failures of yesterday, and with worries over the problems of tomorrow, we have no today in which to be thankful.

Start each day with a smile and end it with prayer.

The really Special person is the one who treats All others as though they were Special. You cannot live a perfect day, without doing something for someone who will never be able to repay you. Amen.

- Bonnie Cumberland

Reflections from the Pastor

As I transition to a new place and a new position, people have asked, why Dixon, why First Pres? Because there are so many possibilities! Dixon is a lovely little town with things going on, a lovely main street, a beautiful river, and nature all around. It felt so comfortable when I visited. And I loved that FPC is active in the community, seeking to make a difference. There is a beautiful, thriving community garden on land that was sitting empty. People were excited about working with Habitat for Humanity and the idea of throwing a shower for the new Habitat family. There are community groups that have been welcomed into the building as a place to meet. And you are open to continuing to explore the ways that God can use you and the resources that God has given you.

I believe that my job as a pastor is to work with you, to support and encourage you. I am excited to get to know each of you better. I want to hear about the things that excite you and help to equip you to be an active part of the congregation, and find the ways that your gifts and talents overlap with the mission and ministry of the church. God created all of us in God's image, and everyone has a place here and should feel welcome!

I love hearing stories and history. What are favorite traditions or the things that you think make FPC special? But at the same time, think outside the box. What are ways that we can become more of the family of God? How can we better love and support each other? Are there needs in the community that aren't being met, that God may be calling us to? Are there good things happening in the community that we can join in and support?

Feel free to stop by the office and share or tell stories over coffee after church. I am delighted to be here and excited to see where God is calling us to be God's hands and feet in this world!

OCTOBER 2025 SCHEDULE OF WORSHIP HELPERS

October 5, 2025 17th Sunday after Pentecost
Musician: Anne Badger
Elder: Phil Vella & Liturgist: Toni Vella
Ushers: Bonnie Cumberland &
A/V: Angie & Dan Montague
Fellowship Host: Vicki & Chuck Jones
Communion Preparer: Peggy Hamilton & Jane Landreth

October 12, 2025 18th Sunday after Pentecost
Musician: Crystal Kalebaugh-Green
Elder & Liturgist: Chuck Devers
Ushers:
A/V: Cathy Anderson & Phil Vella
Fellowship Host: Amy & David Badger

October 19, 2025 19th Sunday after Pentecost
Musician: Crystal Kalebaugh-Green
Elder & Liturgist: Sarah Bingaman
Ushers:
A/V: Angie & Dan Montague
Fellowship Host: Sheri Hill & Gayle Topping

If you would like to help with our Sunday tasks let Pastor or Lois know which one and they will connect you with that scheduler. Thank you!

October 26, 2025 20th Sunday after Pentecost
Musician: Carolyn McBride
Elder & Liturgist: Susie Smith
Ushers:
A/V: Angie & Dan Montague
Fellowship Hosts:

November 2, 2025 21st Sunday after Pentecost
Musician:
Elder & Liturgist: Phil Devers
Ushers:
A/V:
Fellowship Hosts:
Communion Preparer:

October Birthday & Anniversaries

3 rd	Evelyn Thomas
4 th	Lesia Bothe
7 th	Carol Shippert
8 th	Shane Coers
10 th	Faye Nicklaus
11 th	Mabel Losey
	Ryan & Jessica Anderson (A)
12 th	Walt Clevenger
16 th	Paul Katner
21 st	Genevieve McBride
22 nd	Crystal Kalebaugh-Green
	Kaylie Pratt
	Bob Thomas
23 rd	Lane Longtin
26 th	Chuck Beckman

October 2025

Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
			1 5:00pm Christian Education Committee	2 4:00pm Caregiver Support Meeting	3	4
5 8:00am Choir Rehearsal 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour	6 6:00pm Quilters Meeting	7 9:30am Innermission Committee 12:30pm Worship Committee Meeting 3:00pm Mission/Witness Committee 4:00pm Finance & Property Committee	8	9 6:00pm PEO Chapter KM Meeting	10	11
12 8:00am Choir Rehearsal 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour	13	14	15 Newsletter Deadline	16 4:00pm Caregiver Support Meeting	17	18
19 8:00am Choir Rehearsal 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour	20 1:30pm Presbyterian Women	21 6:30pm Session Meeting	22	23	24	25 Habitat Work Day - Start Time TBA 1:00pm Habitat Shower
26 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour	27	28	29	30	31	



First Presbyterian Church of Dixon

Sunday Service: 9:30 a.m.

Find us on Facebook & YouTube.

www.fpcdixon.com

Pastor: Rev. Nikelle Johnson
Administrative Assistant: Lois Grimm
Custodian: Julie Glenn

Music Director: Kathleen Schaefer
A/V Tech: Carolyn McBride

OUR PURPOSE STATEMENT

As followers of Jesus Christ, we will, by our intentional actions,
seek a deeper relationship with God,
listen for the Spirit's call to mission in our community,
and prayerfully lead others to know the joy of God's love,
and to realize God's purpose for life's journey.

